

Googling up!

Learning to live without Google on a Windows Phone 8. Yes, it's possible.

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As it was made clear recently, Windows' support for Google and its apps has reached a bare minimum. Unfortunately, not an essential minimum, which means we get to write a workshop on how to survive this harsh reality for all you people who own Windows phones and have joined the majority of the masses when it comes to Google reliance. Here goes:

Let's get past the 'People'

Based on a post on WP8 forums (<http://digit.in/Wintrum>) it would appear that if you decide to reset your phone, or for any



Export contacts for Outlook from Gmail

reason delete your Google sync account, that's the end of it. It will synchronize your emails, but your Google contacts and calendar will cease to exist. So step numero Uno: Don't do it.

Oh. You already did? Pity. But don't worry. In all honesty, it is an inconvenience, but not one that's too complicated to handle. Sign into your Google account on your PC and enter the 'Contacts' tab. In the 'More' drop box, enter the 'Export...' menu, select 'All contacts' and check the 'Outlook CSV Format'. Save the CSV file wherever convenient on your PC, then log into Outlook in your browser using the Microsoft Live ID your phone is regis-

tered to. Use the drop-down menu on the top left to enter 'People'. Select the 'Import from file' option and browse for your saved CSV file. Your Outlook ID now has your Google contacts all exported and ready to use.

If you want to do away with bothering with two IDs altogether, enter the settings menu (the gear-shaped icon on the top right-hand corner) in your Outlook account and select 'More mail settings'. Select 'Import email accounts' and give Outlook permission to access your Gmail ID and synchronize everything to your Outlook account, and you're a 'People' person again. Only this time, Outlook stores your contacts and email, primarily.

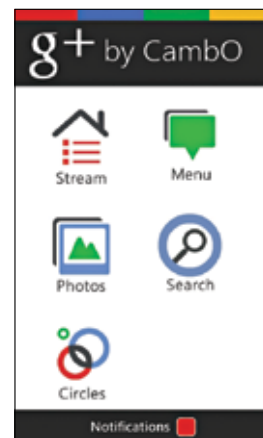
Hanging Out

Can't use your Google account to chat on WP8 because there's no 'Hangout' app? Try IM+.

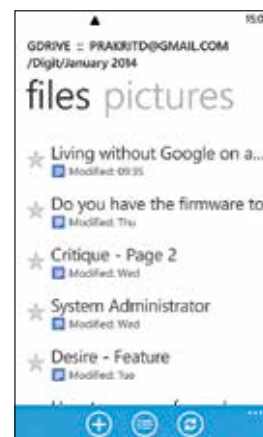
IM+ is a neat app in itself. It synchronizes all your IM-ing into one concrete application. Effectively, you can do away with every instant messaging app and just rely on this. Unless, of course, you're the kind that doesn't like consolidating your chats. It's a smooth app, and easy-to-use.

Gee, plus!

Okay, admittedly, G+ isn't all that popular. But keeping that aside, for all those of



G+ works like a charm



GDrive feels awesome



GMaps: A nice alternative

you who're really into it, iOS and Android offer native Google+ apps. Windows Phone 8 mostly has third-party replacements that display a mobile view of the website.

After trying a few other options, one of the best alternatives for Google+ is the Google Plus Viewer. It's free and has a pretty smooth user interface.

Drive through

This app's so good that it feels like the real thing. After an hour of testing, we realized that this app is NOT by Google. GDrive by Pedro Lamas is your Google Drive sync app on the WP8. It provides a very neat mobile interface to view your Google Drive files. With the exception of eBooks, GDrive could open pretty much any file directly off the app.

Find your way

No. No official Google map app for WP8, just yet. For Windows users who aren't too fond of HERE Maps (previously known as Nokia Maps), and who can't have official Google Maps, the best third-party replacement for Google Maps is gMaps by Dream Team Mobile. You could pay ₹135 for it, or simply download the ad-friendly version. The UI is a lot friendlier than most other map apps. 